Mobile Tool Library: Proposal to the City Neighborhood Grant

Eastside Neighbors Association asks the City Neighborhood Grant committee for $18,500 to start a Mobile Tool Library. A used cargo van stocked with drills, ladders, saws, and garden tools will visit three neighborhoods each week and lend tools for free. We plan to launch on Saturday, April 3, 2027. Applications close December 1, 2026.

Contact: Rosa Delgado, program lead.

Need

In September 2026 we surveyed 212 households. 38% said they lack basic tools for home repairs, which is about 81 households in the sample (computed from the survey figures). Residents told us that buying tools for one repair is not worth the cost, so repairs get put off.

Plan

- January to February 2027: buy a used cargo van and shelving.
- February to March 2027: buy the starter tool inventory.
- March 2027: train 20 volunteers.
- April 3, 2027: launch.

After launch, the van visits three neighborhoods weekly, on Tuesday evenings and Saturday mornings. Neighborhoods and stops: [needs: names of the three neighborhoods and the weekly schedule by stop]. Borrowers sign a one-page waiver, and tools are logged out in a sign-out log for 7-day loans.

Budget

Item	Cost (USD)
Used cargo van	9,800
Shelving and racks	1,950
Starter tool inventory	4,200
Insurance (first year)	1,150
Waivers and printing	400
Volunteer training	1,000
Total	18,500

The total equals the amount requested. Van maintenance is not in this budget. We will pay for it from donations.

Risks

- Van breakdown: A maintenance fund from donations covers repairs, not this grant.
- Tools not returned: Borrowers sign a waiver and a sign-out log, and expensive items carry a small deposit.
- Volunteer turnover: We train 20 volunteers in March 2027 and plan to train 10 more in September 2027.

Measuring success

By April 2028, the end of the first year, we aim for 400 tool loans to 150 different households. We will report to the committee quarterly.